

Meet the 2025 CCBC Judges



Debbie Davis
Chief Judge

Deborah Davis is a retired band director, having spent the last 25 years of her career in the Edgecombe County Public School system. While there, her middle school bands earned more than 20 “superior” ratings at concert festivals. Ms. Davis is an honor graduate of East Carolina University with Bachelor’s and Master’s degrees in Music Education and has been a National Board Certified Teacher since 2003. In addition to maintaining memberships in several professional organizations, she served as the NC Bandmasters Association Eastern District President and chaired the Eastern District’s middle school Music Performance Assessment for many years. Davis was elected to membership in the American School Band Director’s Association and has received the NCBA Eastern District Award of Excellence. She is currently serving as an adjunct music instructor at Edgecombe Community College and remains active as a clinician and adjudicator. She is the co-owner of Down South Accounting & Tax in Greenville NC.

Announcer: Dr. Jeff Murphy
Timing and Penalties Judge: Analise Benitez
Gate Official: Megan Smith

Brad Langhans

**Prelims: Music Performance
Individual
Finals: Music Effect**

Brad Langhans taught band in eastern North Carolina for 22 years, 18 of them at West Craven High School in Vanceboro, North Carolina. He received his Bachelor of Music Education degree and Masters in Music Education degree from East Carolina University. Brad received the Award of Excellence by the North Carolina Bandmasters Association and is also a National Board Certified Teacher. The West Craven High School band program has over 175 students involved annually, with students participating in marching band, symphonic band, jazz band, indoor guard, indoor percussion, and chamber music ensembles. The band has received consistent Superior and Excellent Ratings at all marching and concert festivals. Several West Craven graduates are now music educators or working in a music related field.

He has served as a clinical teacher and mentor for over 20 interns from East Carolina University. Many of those interns are now music educators in North Carolina. Mr. Langhans has also been active in his school and community, serving on the West Craven school leadership cabinet and as Fine Arts Department Chair. In 2003, he joined the Craven Community Concert Band, eventually serving as conductor of the band from 2005 through 2008.

Mr. Langhans has been an active member of the North Carolina Bandmasters Association-Eastern District, serving as 9/10 All District auditions/clinic chair and Secretary in addition to serving as 11/12 Honors Band Auditions chair. He is a member of Music Educators National Conference, Phi Mu Alpha Sinfonia, and the American School Band Directors Association. He has two sons - Griffin is currently serving in the United States Navy and Hunter is a music educator in Pflugerville, Texas. He resides in Durham, NC, with his wife, Deborah.

David Robinson

**Prelims: Music Performance
Ensemble
Finals: Music Performance
Individual**

Mr. David Robinson is a native of Yorktown, VA and graduated from York High School. He received his bachelor in Music Education, from Shenandoah Conservatory of Music. He began his teaching career at Jordan High School in Durham, NC where he taught for 20 years. In 2006 he opened Panther Creek High Band program where he teaches Instrumental Music and is the Arts Department Chair. Since he has been the Director of Bands at Jordan High School and Panther Creek High School he has maintained a well-rounded music program. His Wind Symphony has received straight superior ratings in grade six music. The Marching Band consistently receives top honors for their performances. The Jazz Ensemble and Jazz Combo have a great tradition of success always maintaining a high standard of performance with an emphasis on improvisation and composition.

Mr. Robinson was the instrumental music director for the Brightleaf Music Workshop for 16 years, where his duties have included arranging, performing, and serving as a clinician. He also performs regularly within the Raleigh and Durham community on Clarinet and Saxophone. He was elected the North Carolina Central District "Band Director of the Year" in 1997, and received the "Award of Excellence" in 2000. Mr. Robinson was selected by School Band and Orchestra Magazine as the 2012 North Carolina representative of 50 Directors who make a difference. Mr. Robinson received his National Board Certificate in 2001 and renewal in 2012. His professional affiliations include National Association for Music Education, Phi Mu Alpha: Professional Music Fraternity, and the Central District Bandmasters Association. Mr. Robinson's greatest achievement was to be lucky enough to marry his wife Kim. They have been married for 21 years and have a beautiful daughter (Taylor, 18) and talented son (Ben, 15).

Jim Kirkpatrick

Prelims: Music Effect

Finals: Music Performance Ensemble

Mr. Jim Kirkpatrick is a respected conductor, clinician, and music educator with a distinguished career spanning more than 25 years. He is a founding faculty member and Instructor of Instrumental Music at the North Carolina School of Science and Mathematics – Morganton. He leads a vibrant instrumental music program and mentors a Summer Research and Innovation Project exploring the impact of music therapy on individuals with dementia. He is also the founder of the Burke Youth Wind Symphony, a collaborative community ensemble composed of musicians from NCSSM and surrounding high schools.

Prior to this appointment, Mr. Kirkpatrick directed award-winning music programs at T.C. Roberson High School (Asheville), West Forsyth High School (Clemmons), and North Forsyth High School (Winston-Salem). Under his leadership, ensembles earned more than 40 superior ratings at adjudicated performances and received two invitations to perform at the North Carolina Music Educators Association (NCMEA) State Conference. At the 2014 NCMEA conference, the West Forsyth Wind Ensemble premiered *Bounce* by acclaimed composer Nathan Daughtrey—a commissioned work showcasing the talents of jazz trumpeter and North Carolina native Mike Sailors (UT Austin).

A strong advocate for innovation in percussion education, Mr. Kirkpatrick has developed programs featuring a broad range of ensembles, from percussion orchestra to world music ensembles. His percussion background brings a unique rhythmic and textural sensitivity to his conducting, along with a deep commitment to training percussionists in both solo and ensemble settings. He has presented dozens of clinics on percussion techniques, sectional development, and equipment repair—most notably at the NC ASBDA Summer Institute and Building Better Bands Workshops.

Mr. Kirkpatrick holds both Bachelor's and Master's degrees in Music from the University of North Carolina at Greensboro, where he received the Thomas Stone Award for Outstanding Musicianship. He also completed a fellowship at the John F. Kennedy Center for the Performing Arts, collaborating with musicians and educators across the Greater Washington, D.C. area. A National Board Certified Teacher since 2002, he has served as both assessor and mentor for the National Board for Professional Teaching Standards.

His leadership extends beyond the classroom. Mr. Kirkpatrick has served as President and Secretary of the North Carolina Bandmasters Association and has contributed to the North Carolina Department of Public Instruction for over a decade, including appointments to several State Superintendent's Advisory Committees. He has appeared as a guest conductor and adjudicator at more than 75 festivals, honor bands, and music performance assessments throughout the Southeastern United States. For over twenty years, he has also served as a conductor at the University of North Carolina at Greensboro Summer Music Camp—the largest university-based music camp in the nation.

In recognition of his excellence in teaching and leadership, Mr. Kirkpatrick has been named a Grammy Music Educator of the Year Quarterfinalist, received the NCBA Award of Excellence, was honored as Band Director of the Year for Winston-Salem/Forsyth County Schools, and has been inducted into the American School Band Directors Association. His professional affiliations include NAFME, NCMEA, NCBA, PAS, and ASBDA.

Paul Orsett

Prelims: Visual Effect

Finals: Visual Performance

Paul A. Orsett is from Knightdale, NC and is currently a full time theatre arts teacher at Wakefield High School in Raleigh, NC. He received his undergraduate degree in Music Education from East Carolina University in Greenville, NC and his Masters degree in Directing Theatre from Roosevelt University in Chicago, Ill.

Paul marched with the Cavaliers Drum & Bugle Corps and Winter Guard of Rosemont, Illinois. He founded Assembly Line Winter Guard in 1985 and co-directed the three time Tarheel Invitational Champion Northern Nash Marching Knights from Rocky Mount, NC. He is Executive Director of the Atlantic Indoor Association and has 35+ years of teaching experience, including Drum & Bugle Corps, marching band, Winter Guard and theatre. Paul is also an official announcer for Atlantic Indoor Association and Winter Guard International Regional Competitions and WGI World Championships.

Stephanie Stewart

Prelims: Visual Performance

Finals: Visual Effect

Stephanie Renell Stewart is from the Atlanta, Georgia area and has been involved with marching arts programs across the country for over 25 years. She is currently working with Paramount Winter guard. Her experience also includes Carolina Crown Winterguard, Phantom Regiment Winterguard and various high schools in the area. Stephanie began her teaching career immediately after graduation with Seminole High School Marching Band.

She has worked with other programs including Kennesaw Mountain High School band, the Knights, Cypress Creek High School, Freedom High School and Seminole High!

She has worked with drum corps including Carolina Crown, Phantom Regiment, Boston Crusaders, Madison Scouts, and Santa Clara Vanguard. She is currently a judge with the Gulf Coast Judges Association and judges across the country during fall and Winterguard seasons.

Daniel Adams

Prelims: Visual Ensemble

Finals: Visual Ensemble

Daniel Adams has been actively involved in the colorguard community since 2014, bringing over a decade of combined performance and teaching experience to the field. As a performer, Daniel spent five seasons with First Flight Winterguard from 2014 - 2019. He also marched with the Madison Scouts Drum and Bugle Corps during the 2015 and 2016 DCI seasons. Transitioning into coaching, Daniel has contributed choreography and technical instruction to several successful high school programs across North Carolina, including Holly Springs High School, Green Hope High School, and Wakefield High School. Daniel has a Ph.D. in Comparative Biomedical Sciences from North Carolina State University, and works full-time in the Animal Nutrition and Health industry.

Jim Boyce

Prelims: Percussion
Finals: Percussion

James Boyce, Jr. graduated from East Carolina University in 2006 with a bachelors in Music Education. Since graduation, he has served music organizations across the United States through teaching and music composition. His formal experience began with instructing and arranging for the Havelock High School percussion program in Havelock, NC from 2005-2010. During this time, he was also an instructor for the 2007 West Carteret High School Indoor Percussion Theater (2007 WGI Scholastic A Regional Champion). In 2008, Jim was a co-front ensemble instructor with the WGI Independent World indoor percussion ensemble, Constitution. In 2009, Jim's growing interest in the indoor percussion activity led him to found, direct, and co-design the WGI Independent A percussion ensemble, Craven. In 2010 they received a Bronze Medal at the WGI World Championships under his direction.

While freelance percussion teaching and composing is a passion, Jim's career has been in public education. From 2006 to 2010, he taught band at Havelock Middle School in Havelock, NC where his ensembles consistently received excellent and superior ratings. From 2010-2013, Jim was the Assistant Director of Bands and the Percussion Director at Northern Nash High School in Rocky Mount, NC. While in this position, the percussion program was honored to perform twice with the East Carolina University Percussion studio, receive a gold medal at the 2011 Atlantic Indoor Association Championships, win their class at the 2012 Spartanburg WGI Regional, receive silver medals at the 2012 and 2013 Atlantic Indoor Association Championships, and perform at the 2013 NC Day of Percussion East. Following his tenure at Northern Nash, Jim assisted with the opening of a new school and band program at Rocky Mount Middle, serving as the band director and then assistant principal of the school. Throughout his teaching career, Jim also taught privately, having multiple students participate in the NC All-State Bands and go on to major in music at prominent universities. Jim went on to become the Assistant Principal of Instruction at Charles E. Jordan High School in Durham, NC, where he served for 8 years. He is now in his third year as principal of Forest View Elementary School in Durham.

Jim has held memberships in the National Association of Music Educators, the North Carolina Band Master's Association and the Percussive Arts Society. He has also served on the North Carolina Band Master's State Marching Band Committee and the Winter Guard International Percussion Advisory Board. Jim currently resides with his wife and two daughters in Chapel Hill, NC, and hopes that both his service in education and musical compositions will lead students to more fulfilling lives.

Jim is a proud member of the Vic Firth Education team and his musical compositions can be found at marchingmonk.com.

Sarah Fresquez

Prelims: Drum Major
Finals: Drum Major

Sarah Fresquez is a recent graduate of East Carolina University in Greenville, NC, where she received her Bachelor's and Master's degrees in Public Health. Sarah began her high school marching band career on flute in 2015, and she first served as a drum major in 2018. At the collegiate level, she marched for one year on piccolo before serving four years as drum major for the East Carolina University Marching Pirates.

Sarah enjoys sharing her passions for field conducting and servant leadership through her work as a drum major instructor and mentor. Outside of her musical career, she has six scientific publications and has presented her research at the international level. Sarah additionally works at the Brody School of Medicine as a physical assessment trainer while she prepares to apply for doctoral programs.